

Absolutely. I'll make your **DCCN (CS24305) Master Notes** in the same style as CD: **complete M1–M5 coverage, no syllabus topic intentionally skipped, exam-focused explanations, formulas, diagrams, active-recall prompts, memory hooks, and actual uploaded-paper questions clearly separated from syllabus/question-bank questions.**

Your uploaded study guide lists **52 DCCN topics: 13 + 6 + 8 + 9 + 16.**

One important distinction: the uploaded papers include **AI323/IT365 DCCN papers**, including 2025 mid/end papers, but they are not labelled CS24305 CSE papers. I'll therefore mark those as **[UPLOADED PYQ]**, rather than pretending they are your exact CSE paper. Your uploaded study guide also contains a DCCN question bank covering the syllabus.

## **DCCN — COMPLETE MASTER NOTES**

### **CS24305 | Data Communication & Computer Networks**

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## **0. THE ONE BIG PICTURE**

Before memorizing anything, build this mental model:

```
DATA
↓
SIGNAL
↓
TRANSMISSION MEDIA
↓
ENCODING / MODULATION
↓
DATA LINK
↓
SWITCHING
↓
NETWORK / IP
↓
ROUTING
↓
TRANSPORT
↓
APPLICATION
```

Or think:

#### **Key Insight**

**Send → Encode → Carry → Detect Errors → Control → Switch → Route → Deliver → Application**

This single chain connects almost the entire syllabus.

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## **MODULE I — DATA COMMUNICATION & NETWORKING OVERVIEW**

### **13 topics**

Your syllabus covers Communication Model, Data Communication, Networks, Internet, OSI, TCP/IP, standards/layers, applications, transmission concepts, analog/digital transmission, impairments and channel capacity.

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# 1. Communication Model

Basic communication:



## Components

| Component | Meaning                          |
|-----------|----------------------------------|
| Sender    | Generates data                   |
| Receiver  | Receives data                    |
| Message   | Information being transmitted    |
| Medium    | Physical/wireless path           |
| Encoder   | Converts information into signal |
| Decoder   | Recovers information             |
| Protocol  | Rules governing communication    |

## Protocol

A protocol defines:

syntax  
semantics  
timing  
sequence  
error handling

## Memory hook

**S-M-M-P**

**S**ender → **M**essage → **M**edium → **P**rotocol

---

# 2. Data Communications

Data communication = exchange of data between devices through a communication medium.

## Characteristics

Good communication should provide:

- delivery
- accuracy
- timeliness
- low jitter

## Data representation

Data can represent:

- text
- numbers
- images
- audio
- video

## Transmission modes

### Simplex



```
graph LR; A --> B
```

One direction only.

Example: traditional television broadcasting.

### Half-duplex



```
graph LR; A --> B; B --> A
```

Both directions, but not simultaneously.

Example: walkie-talkie.

### Full-duplex



```
graph LR; A --> B; B --> A
```

Both directions simultaneously.

Example: telephone.

**[UPLOADED PYQ]** asks for the main transmission modes.

---

## 3. Networks

A computer network is a collection of interconnected devices that communicate and share resources.

### Types by geographical size



```
graph LR; PAN --> LAN; LAN --> MAN; MAN --> WAN
```

## PAN

Personal Area Network.

Small personal range.

Example:

Phone ↔ Earbuds ↔ Smartwatch

## LAN

Local Area Network.

building/campus

high speed

usually privately managed

## MAN

Metropolitan Area Network.

Covers a city/metropolitan region.

## WAN

Wide Area Network.

Covers large geographical regions.

Example: Internet.

## Comparison

| PAN        | LAN             | MAN    | WAN           |
|------------|-----------------|--------|---------------|
| Personal   | Building/campus | City   | Country/world |
| Very small | Small           | Medium | Huge          |

---

# 4. Internet

The Internet is a global **network of interconnected networks** using the TCP/IP protocol suite.

```
Device
↓
LAN
↓
Router
↓
ISP
↓
Internet
↓
Server
```

Important ideas:

packet switching

routers  
IP addressing  
TCP/UDP  
DNS  
application protocols  
---

## 5. OSI Model

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The OSI model contains **7 layers**.

```
7 Application
6 Presentation
5 Session
4 Transport
3 Network
2 Data Link
1 Physical
```

### Memory trick

#### Key Insight

**All People Seem To Need Data Processing**

A → P → S → T → N → D → P

---

### Layer 7 — Application

---

Provides network services to applications.

Examples:

HTTP  
FTP  
SMTP  
DNS  
---

### Layer 6 — Presentation

---

Deals with:

translation  
encryption/decryption  
compression  
Example:

```
ASCII ↔ another representation
```

---

## Layer 5 — Session

---

Manages sessions/dialogues.

Functions:

- establish session
- maintain session
- terminate session
- synchronization
- 

## Layer 4 — Transport

---

End-to-end delivery.

Important concepts:

- segmentation
- reassembly
- flow control
- error control
- reliability

Protocols:

- TCP
- UDP
- 

## Layer 3 — Network

---

Responsible for:

- logical addressing
- routing
- packet forwarding

Protocol:

- IP

Device:

- router
- 

## Layer 2 — Data Link

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Responsible for:

- framing
- MAC addressing
- error detection
- flow control
- medium access

Devices:

switches/bridges

---

## Layer 1 — Physical

---

Transmits raw bits.

Deals with:

voltage

connectors

cables

bit transmission

signal characteristics

---

## 6. TCP/IP Protocol Architecture

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Your syllabus specifically includes TCP/IP architecture.

Common 4-layer representation:

```
Application
  ↓
Transport
  ↓
Internet
  ↓
Network Access
```

### Application

HTTP, DNS, SMTP, FTP, DHCP etc.

### Transport

TCP / UDP.

### Internet

IP, ICMP etc.

### Network Access

Physical transmission + data-link functionality.

---

## OSI vs TCP/IP

| OSI                             | TCP/IP                              |
|---------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| 7 layers                        | 4-layer representation              |
| Reference model                 | Protocol architecture               |
| Developed by ISO                | Developed around Internet protocols |
| Session & Presentation separate | Usually part of Application         |
| Data Link + Physical separate   | Often combined as Network Access    |

[UPLOADED PYQ] directly asks to compare OSI and TCP/IP.

[UPLOADED PYQ] also asks TCP/IP architecture and layer functions.

---

## 7. Standards and Protocol Layers

Layering divides networking into manageable functions.

```
Application
-----
Transport
-----
Network
-----
Data Link
-----
Physical
```

### Why layering?

modularity  
easier design  
easier troubleshooting  
interoperability  
independent development

### Encapsulation

Sender:

```
Application Data
  ↓
Transport Segment
  ↓
Network Packet
  ↓
Data-Link Frame
  ↓
Bits
```

Receiver performs reverse:



Bits  
↓  
Frame  
↓  
Packet  
↓  
Segment  
↓  
Data

## 8. Internet Applications

| Application          | Protocol   |
|----------------------|------------|
| Web                  | HTTP/HTTPS |
| Email sending        | SMTP       |
| Email retrieval      | POP3/IMAP  |
| File transfer        | FTP        |
| Name resolution      | DNS        |
| Automatic addressing | DHCP       |
| Secure remote login  | SSH        |

## 9. Data Transmission Concepts & Terminology

### Bit rate

Bits transmitted per second.

bps

### Baud rate

Symbols transmitted per second.

If each symbol carries one bit:

$\text{baud} = \text{bit/s}$

Otherwise:

$\text{Bit rate} = \text{Baud rate} \times \text{bits/symbol}$

## Bandwidth

---

Frequency range available to a channel.

For analog channel:

$$\text{Bandwidth} = f_{\text{high}} - f_{\text{low}}$$

## Throughput

---

Actual achieved data rate.

Usually:

$$\text{Throughput} \leq \text{theoretical data rate}$$

## Latency

---

Total delay experienced by data.

Major components:

```
Transmission delay
+
Propagation delay
+
Processing delay
+
Queuing delay
```

### Transmission delay

Time to push bits onto link:

$$T_{\text{trans}} = \text{Packet size} / \text{Data rate}$$

### Propagation delay

Time for signal to travel:

$$T_{\text{prop}} = \text{Distance} / \text{Propagation speed}$$

### Jitter

Variation in packet delay.

Especially important for:

voice

video

real-time applications

---

## 10. Analog Data Transmission

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Analog signal varies continuously.



Parameters:

amplitude

frequency

phase

---

## 11. Digital Data Transmission

Digital signal uses discrete levels.



Typically represented using binary values.

### Analog vs Digital

| Analog                                | Digital                     |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Continuous                            | Discrete                    |
| More susceptible to accumulated noise | Better noise regeneration   |
| Uses continuous waveform              | Uses discrete signal levels |
| Traditional radio/voice systems       | Computers/data networks     |

---

## 12. Transmission Impairments

Three major impairments:

Attenuation  
Distortion  
Noise

### Attenuation

Signal loses strength with distance.

Measured commonly in decibels.

Received power < Transmitted power

## Distortion

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Signal shape changes.

Different frequency components may experience different delays/attenuation.

## Noise

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Unwanted signal added to desired signal.

Types:

thermal

intermodulation

crosstalk

impulse

**[UPLOADED PYQ]** asks specifically about major transmission impairments and their effect on signal quality.

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# 13. Channel Capacity

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Maximum theoretical rate at which information can be transmitted reliably.

## Nyquist theorem

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For a noiseless channel:

$$C = 2B \log_2 L$$

where:

B = bandwidth

L = number of signal levels

## Shannon theorem

---

For noisy channel:

$$C = B \log_2(1 + S/N)$$

where:

C = capacity

B = bandwidth

S/N = signal-to-noise ratio

If SNR is in dB:

$$SNR_{linear} = 10^{(SNR_{dB}/10)}$$

## Key distinction

### Key Insight

Nyquist → noiseless

### Key Insight

Shannon → noisy

[UPLOADED PYQ] asks Shannon capacity directly.

---

## M1 ACTIVE RECALL

Without looking:

What are the five basic components of data communication?

Simplex vs half-duplex vs full-duplex?

PAN/LAN/MAN/WAN?

Name all seven OSI layers.

What does each OSI layer do?

OSI vs TCP/IP?

What is encapsulation?

Bit rate vs baud rate?

Transmission vs propagation delay?

Attenuation vs distortion vs noise?

Nyquist formula?

Shannon formula?

---

## MODULE II — TRANSMISSION MEDIA & SIGNAL ENCODING

### 6 topics

The uploaded syllabus lists Guided Media, Wireless Transmission & Propagation, Digital Signaling, Analog Signaling, Encoding and Modulation.

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## 14. Guided Transmission Media

Signals travel through physical media.

### Guided

- Twisted Pair
- Coaxial
- Optical Fiber

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## Twisted Pair

---

Two insulated copper wires twisted together.

### Types

#### UTP

Unshielded Twisted Pair.

#### STP

Shielded Twisted Pair.

### Advantages

inexpensive

easy installation

widely available

### Disadvantages

electromagnetic interference

lower bandwidth than fiber

attenuation

---

## Coaxial Cable

---

Structure:



Better shielding than twisted pair.

Applications:

cable TV

broadband

older Ethernet

---

## Optical Fiber

---

Uses light instead of electrical signals.

Light



Core

Cladding

Jacket

Principle:

#### Key Insight

Total Internal Reflection

#### Advantages

huge bandwidth

low attenuation

EMI immunity

lightweight

secure against electromagnetic interception

#### Disadvantages

installation complexity

higher equipment cost

fragile compared with copper

#### Memory

#### Key Insight

Copper carries electrons; fiber carries light.

## 15. Wireless Transmission & Propagation

Unguided media:

Radio

Microwave

Infrared

Satellite

#### Propagation methods

##### Ground wave

Follows Earth's surface.

##### Sky wave

Signal reflected/refracted by ionospheric region.

##### Line-of-sight

Direct path between antennas.

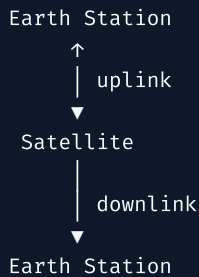


```
graph LR; A --> B
```

Used heavily by microwave communication.

---

## Satellite Communication



### Advantages

- huge coverage
- useful for remote regions
- broadcasting

### Disadvantages

- high propagation delay
- expensive
- weather effects for some bands
- requires satellite infrastructure

**[UPLOADED PYQ]** asks the physical description/transmission characteristics of satellite microwave and satellite-vs-terrestrial microwave.

---

## 16. Digital Signaling

Digital data must be represented by physical signal patterns.

Important line codes:

- NRZ-L
- NRZ-I/NRZI
- Manchester
- Differential Manchester
- Bipolar AMI

---

### NRZ-L

Signal level represents bit value.

Convention depends on specification.



Key issue:

### Key Insight

Long sequences of same bits can cause synchronization problems.

---

## NRZ-I

A transition represents one binary value; no transition represents the other.

The exact convention must be stated.

**[UPLOADED PYQ]** asks NRZI and Differential Manchester waveforms.

---

## Manchester

Every bit has a transition in the middle.

This provides synchronization.

Typical convention:

```
1 → high-to-low  
0 → low-to-high
```

But always follow the convention specified by your teacher/question.

### Key advantage

Self-clocking.

---

## Differential Manchester

There is always a transition in the middle.

The transition at the beginning determines the bit value.

Again, conventions may differ.

---

## Bipolar AMI

```
0 → zero level  
1 → alternating +V and -V
```

Example:

```
1 0 1 1 0 1  
+ 0 - + 0 -
```

---

## 17. Analog Signaling

Digital data can be represented by changing a carrier wave.

Carrier:

$$c(t) = A_c \cos(2\pi f_c t + \varphi)$$

Three fundamental parameters:

amplitude

frequency

phase

Changing one creates modulation.

---

## 18. Encoding Techniques

### Encoding

Maps data into a signal suitable for transmission.

Bits → Line Code → Signal

Important techniques:

| Technique               | Main idea                                   |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------|
| NRZ-L                   | Level represents data                       |
| NRZ-I                   | Transition represents data                  |
| Manchester              | Mid-bit transition                          |
| Differential Manchester | Mid-bit transition + differential beginning |
| AMI                     | Bipolar representation                      |

### [UPLOADED PYQ]

For **001110011**, the paper asks you to draw:

NRZ-L

NRZ-I

Bipolar AMI

Manchester

Differential Manchester

This is a **must-practice waveform question**.

---

## 19. Modulation Techniques

Modulation changes a carrier according to information.

## ASK

Amplitude Shift Keying.

```
1 → carrier present  
0 → carrier absent/different amplitude
```

## FSK

Frequency Shift Keying.

```
1 → f1  
0 → f2
```

## PSK

Phase Shift Keying.

```
1 → phase  $\varphi_1$   
0 → phase  $\varphi_2$ 
```

## QAM

Quadrature Amplitude Modulation.

Changes:

amplitude

phase

simultaneously.

### General comparison

| ASK       | FSK       | PSK                    | QAM                |
|-----------|-----------|------------------------|--------------------|
| Amplitude | Frequency | Phase                  | Amplitude + phase  |
| Simple    | Robust    | Good noise performance | High data capacity |

---

## M2 ACTIVE RECALL

Twisted pair vs coaxial vs fiber?

Why is fiber resistant to EMI?

What is total internal reflection?

Ground vs sky vs LOS propagation?

Satellite vs terrestrial microwave?

NRZ-L vs NRZ-I?

Why does Manchester help synchronization?

What happens in AMI?

ASK/FSK/PSK/QAM?  
Encoding vs modulation?  
---

## MODULE III — ERROR HANDLING, DATA LINK CONTROL & MULTIPLEXING

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### 8 topics

The syllabus contains errors, detection, correction, flow/error control, HDLC, FDM and TDM.  
---

## 20. Types of Errors

---

### Single-bit error

---

Only one bit changes.

```
Sent:      101101
Received:101001
```

### Burst error

---

Multiple bits in a sequence are affected.

```
Sent:      1100110011
Received:1101001011
```

Burst errors are particularly important in practical communication channels.  
---

## 21. Error Detection Techniques

---

Goal:

#### Key Insight

Detect whether received data has been corrupted.

Main techniques:

```
Parity
Checksum
CRC
```

### Parity

---

Add one bit.

### Even parity

Total number of 1s becomes even.

### Odd parity

Total number of 1s becomes odd.

### Limitation

A single parity bit is not sufficient for detecting every possible error pattern.

[**UPLOADED PYQ**] directly asks what a parity bit is and how it detects errors.

---

## 22. Checksum

---

Basic idea:

```
Data words
↓
Add
↓
Complement
↓
Checksum
```

Receiver performs corresponding calculation.

Used historically/in various network protocols including transport/network contexts.

---

## 23. CRC

---

**Cyclic Redundancy Check** is one of the most important DCCN numerical topics.

Given:

```
Data = D
Generator = G
```

If generator degree =  $r$ :

Append  $r$  zeros to data.

Perform modulo-2 division.

Remainder = CRC.

Append remainder to original data.

```
Transmitted frame = Data + CRC
```

### Modulo-2 arithmetic

Subtraction = XOR.

```
0 XOR 0 = 0
0 XOR 1 = 1
1 XOR 0 = 1
1 XOR 1 = 0
```

### Receiver

Divide received frame by generator.

```
remainder = 0
```

means no detected error under the CRC test.

**[UPLOADED PYQ]** asks CRC for:

```
Data = 1010011110
Generator = 1011
```

Another uploaded paper asks:

```
Data = 1101011011
Generator = 10011
```

and requests the complete calculation and transmitted message.

### Must practice

Do not memorize CRC.

Do the binary division repeatedly.

---

## 24. Error Correction Techniques

---

Error correction means recovering/correcting corrupted data.

Two broad approaches:

### Forward Error Correction

Receiver corrects error without retransmission.

Useful when retransmission is expensive or slow.

### Hamming Code

Adds redundant bits at carefully selected positions.

---

### Hamming Code

For  $m$  data bits and  $r$  parity bits:

$$2^r \geq m + r + 1$$

Parity positions:

1, 2, 4, 8, 16, ...

These are powers of two.

Example:

```
Position:
1 2 3 4 5 6 7
P P D P D D D
```

Parity bits cover different position groups.

## Syndrome

The received parity-check results form a binary number.

If syndrome:

000

→ no detected single-bit error.

If:

101

→ error at decimal position 5.

## Memory

### Key Insight

Hamming parity lives at powers of 2.

---

# 25. Flow Control

Flow control prevents a fast sender from overwhelming a slow receiver.

```
Fast Sender → Slow Receiver
          CONTROL
```

Important methods:

Stop-and-Wait

Sliding Window

---

## Stop-and-Wait

```
Sender — Frame 0 → Receiver
Sender ← ACK — Receiver
Sender — Frame 1 →
```

Only one outstanding frame.

## Advantage

Simple.

## Disadvantage

Poor link utilization on long-delay networks.

---

## Sliding Window

Multiple frames can be outstanding.

```
[0][1][2][3][4] →→→
```

Window moves as acknowledgements arrive.

Benefits:

better utilization

higher throughput

supports pipelining

---

# 26. Error Control

Flow control:

### Key Insight

How fast?

Error control:

### Key Insight

Was it received correctly?

Error control uses:

error detection

acknowledgements

retransmission

sequence numbers

timers

## ARQ

Automatic Repeat reQuest.

Important forms:

Stop-and-Wait ARQ

Go-Back-N

Selective Repeat

---



## Go-Back-N

If frame k is lost:

```
0 ✓
1 ✓
2 ✗
3
4
```

sender retransmits from frame 2 onward.

---

## Selective Repeat

Only damaged/missing frames are retransmitted.

```
0 ✓
1 ✓
2 ✗
3 ✓
4 ✓
```

Retransmit only 2.

## Comparison

| GBN                           | Selective Repeat            |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Retransmits from error onward | Retransmits selected frames |
| Simpler                       | More complex                |
| More waste                    | More efficient              |

[UPLOADED PYQ] explicitly asks Sliding Window and Stop-and-Wait ARQ vs Go-Back-N.

---

# 27. HDLC

## High-Level Data Link Control

A bit-oriented data-link protocol.

Basic frame:



## Flag

Identifies frame boundaries.

Common flag pattern:

**Address**

Identifies station.

**Control**

Defines frame type/control information.

**Data**

Payload.

**FCS**

Frame Check Sequence for error detection.

---

**HDLC frame types****I-frame**

Information.

Carries user data.

**S-frame**

Supervisory.

Used for control/acknowledgement.

**U-frame**

Unnumbered.

Used for management/control functions.

**Memory****Key Insight**

I = Information

**Key Insight**

S = Supervisory

**Key Insight**

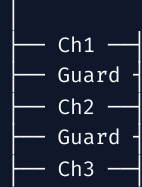
U = Unnumbered

---

**28. FDM****Frequency Division Multiplexing**

Channel bandwidth is divided into frequency bands.

Frequency



Each signal gets a different frequency band.

Applications:

radio

television

analog communication

### Guard bands

Prevent interference between adjacent channels.

---

## 29. TDM

### Time Division Multiplexing

Users share the channel by taking turns in time.

Time →



### Synchronous TDM

Fixed time slot allocated to each source.

Even if source has no data, slot may remain allocated.

### Statistical TDM

Slots dynamically allocated to active sources.

Better utilization but requires more control.

**[UPLOADED PYQ]** asks TDM and explicitly asks synchronous vs asynchronous/statistical TDM.

---

## M3 ACTIVE RECALL

Single-bit vs burst error?

Parity vs checksum vs CRC?

CRC steps?

What is  $2^r \geq m+r+1$  used for?

Where are Hamming parity bits placed?

Flow control vs error control?

Stop-and-Wait?

GBN vs Selective Repeat?  
HDLC frame?  
I/S/U frames?  
FDM vs TDM?  
Synchronous vs statistical TDM?  
---

## MODULE IV — WAN & LAN

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### 9 topics

Your syllabus lists switching, circuit/packet switching, cellular networks, generations, topologies, LAN architecture and VLANs.

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## 30. Switching Network

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Switching allows information to move through intermediate network nodes.

Main approaches:

```
Switching
├── Circuit Switching
└── Packet Switching
```

---

## 31. Circuit-Switching Networks

---

A dedicated path is established before communication.

```
A — S1 — S2 — S3 — B
    dedicated circuit
```

Three phases:

```
Setup
↓
Data transfer
↓
Teardown
```

Advantages:

- predictable path
- predictable delay after setup
- suitable for continuous traffic

Disadvantages:

- setup time
- inefficient for bursty traffic
- dedicated resources may remain unused

---

## 32. Circuit–Switching Concepts

Important characteristics:

- dedicated resources
- call setup
- fixed path
- circuit release

Traditional telephone systems are the classic example.

---

## 33. Packet–Switching Principles

Data is divided into packets.



Packets may share links with other traffic.

Two major approaches:

### Datagram

Each packet independently routed.

### Virtual Circuit

Logical path established; packets follow that logical route.

---

### Circuit vs Packet

| Circuit                     | Packet                     |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------|
| Dedicated path              | Shared network             |
| Setup                       | Usually no dedicated setup |
| Predictable path            | Dynamic                    |
| Good for continuous traffic | Good for bursty traffic    |
| Traditional telephony       | Internet                   |

[UPLOADED PYQ] explicitly asks circuit vs packet switching.

Another uploaded paper asks datagram vs virtual–circuit packet switching.

---

## 34. Principles of Cellular Networks

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A cellular network divides a geographical region into cells.



Each cell has a base station.

### Frequency reuse

Same frequency can be reused in sufficiently separated cells.

Goal:

#### Key Insight

Increase capacity without requiring unique frequencies everywhere.

---

### Handoff

When a mobile moves from one cell to another:



The connection is transferred to another base station.

---

## 35. Cellular Network Generations

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### 1G

analog

voice

### 2G

digital

voice

SMS

improved capacity

### 3G

higher data rates

mobile Internet

## 4G

broadband mobile data

LTE

IP-oriented services

## 5G

very high capacity

low-latency applications

massive device connectivity

IoT-oriented use cases

## Memory

### Key Insight

1 Voice → 2 Digital → 3 Internet → 4 Broadband → 5 Massive Connectivity

# 36. Network Topologies

## Bus

A — B — C — D

Cheap but backbone failure can affect network.

## Star

```
  A
  |
B—Switch—C
  |
  D
```

Easy to manage.

Central device is critical.

## Ring

```
A — B
|   |
D — C
```

Nodes form a ring.

Mesh

Every node has multiple connections.



Very reliable but expensive.

---

Tree

Hierarchical arrangement.



Comparison

| Topology | Major strength        | Major weakness            |
|----------|-----------------------|---------------------------|
| Bus      | Cheap                 | Backbone failure          |
| Star     | Easy management       | Central-device dependency |
| Ring     | Predictable structure | Break can affect ring     |
| Mesh     | Reliability           | Cost                      |
| Tree     | Scalable hierarchy    | More complex              |

---

37. LAN Protocol Architecture

IEEE LAN architecture is associated with the data-link layer and physical layer.

Data Link is commonly divided into:



LLC

Logical Link Control.

Provides higher-level link services.



## MAC

Medium Access Control.

Deals with:

addressing

access to shared medium

frame handling

---

## 38. VLAN

---

### Virtual LAN

A VLAN logically divides a physical LAN.

```
Physical Switch
├── VLAN 10 → Students
├── VLAN 20 → Faculty
└── VLAN 30 → Admin
```

Devices can be physically connected to the same switches but logically separated.

### Benefits

segmentation

security

broadcast-domain reduction

easier management

flexibility

### Memory

#### Key Insight

VLAN = logical LAN, not necessarily physical LAN.

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## M4 ACTIVE RECALL

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What is switching?

Circuit vs packet switching?

Datagram vs virtual circuit?

Three phases of circuit switching?

Why does packet switching suit bursty data?

What is frequency reuse?

What is handoff?

1G → 5G evolution?

Five network topologies?

LLC vs MAC?

Why VLAN?

---

## MODULE V — ETHERNET, IP, ROUTING & APPLICATIONS

---

### 16 topics

The syllabus contains Traditional Ethernet, High-Speed Ethernet, Wi-Fi, IP, addressing, transport, routing, three routing approaches, congestion, traffic management and SMTP/DNS/HTTP/DHCP.

---

## 39. Traditional Ethernet

---

Ethernet is standardized under **IEEE 802.3**.

Traditional Ethernet:

10 Mbps

Historically used:

coaxial cable

twisted pair

Traditional shared-medium Ethernet used **CSMA/CD**.

---

## 40. High-Speed Ethernet

---

Important generations:

|               |            |
|---------------|------------|
| Ethernet      | → 10 Mbps  |
| Fast Ethernet | → 100 Mbps |
| Gigabit       | → 1 Gbps   |
| 10 Gigabit    | → 10 Gbps  |

Higher-speed Ethernet improves:

throughput

latency

network capacity

---

## 41. IEEE 802.11 — Wi-Fi

---

Wireless LAN standard.

Common generations include:

802.11b

802.11a

802.11g

802.11n

802.11ac

802.11ax

Advantages:

mobility

easy deployment

no cable to every endpoint

Challenges:

interference

shared medium

security concerns

variable performance

### Ethernet vs Wi-Fi

| Ethernet                                | Wi-Fi                       |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Wired                                   | Wireless                    |
| IEEE 802.3                              | IEEE 802.11                 |
| Dedicated physical connection typically | Shared radio medium         |
| Generally more stable                   | More interference-sensitive |

---

## 42. Internet Protocol – IP

IP provides logical addressing and packet delivery across interconnected networks.

Main versions:

IPv4  
IPv6

---

### IPv4

32-bit address.

Example:

192.168.1.10

IPv4 header includes fields such as:

Version

Header Length

Total Length

Identification

Flags

Fragment Offset

TTL

Protocol

Header Checksum

Source Address

Destination Address

**[UPLOADED PYQ]** asks the structure and working of IPv4 and purpose of major header fields.

---

## IPv6

128-bit addressing.

Example:

```
2001:db8::1
```

Advantages:

enormous address space

simplified base header

better support for modern networking requirements

extension-header architecture

### IPv4 vs IPv6

| IPv4                                | IPv6                                                    |
|-------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| 32-bit                              | 128-bit                                                 |
| Dotted decimal                      | Hexadecimal                                             |
| Smaller address space               | Huge address space                                      |
| Broadcast exists                    | No conventional broadcast; multicast/anycast mechanisms |
| More dependence on NAT historically | Designed for vastly larger address space                |

---

## 43. IP Addressing

An IP address identifies a network interface logically.

### Classful IPv4 addressing

Traditional classes:

| Class | First octet range | Default mask |
|-------|-------------------|--------------|
| A     | 1-126             | /8           |
| B     | 128-191           | /16          |
| C     | 192-223           | /24          |
| D     | 224-239           | Multicast    |
| E     | 240-255           | Experimental |

### Important special addresses

Private IPv4 ranges:

```
10.0.0.0/8
172.16.0.0/12
192.168.0.0/16
```

---

## Subnetting

Splits a network into smaller networks.

Example:

```
192.168.1.0/24
```

If changed to:

```
/26
```

then:

```
2^(26-24) = 4 subnets
```

Each /26 has:

```
2^(32-26) = 64 addresses
```

Traditionally:

```
62 usable host addresses
```

per ordinary subnet, excluding network and broadcast addresses.

### Must know

```
Number of subnets = 2^borrowed_bits
Addresses/subnet = 2^host_bits
```

---

## 44. Transport Protocols

Main transport protocols:

TCP  
UDP

---

## TCP

---

Transmission Control Protocol.

Properties:

connection-oriented

reliable

ordered

byte-stream

flow control

congestion control

### Three-way handshake



Connection established.

---

## UDP

---

User Datagram Protocol.

Properties:

connectionless

low overhead

no built-in reliability

no ordering guarantee

useful for real-time/latency-sensitive applications

## TCP vs UDP

| TCP                               | UDP                                                          |
|-----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Connection-oriented               | Connectionless                                               |
| Reliable                          | Best-effort                                                  |
| Ordered                           | No ordering guarantee                                        |
| More overhead                     | Low overhead                                                 |
| Flow/congestion control           | No TCP-style mechanisms                                      |
| Web/secure web/file transfer etc. | DNS, streaming/real-time uses, etc. depending on application |

The uploaded DCCN question bank identifies **TCP vs UDP** as one of the highest-priority Module V questions.

---

## 45. Routing in Packet-Switching Networks

Routing determines a path from source to destination.

```
Source
↓
Router
↓
Router
↓
Router
↓
Destination
```

Routing algorithms use metrics such as:

hop count

delay

bandwidth

cost

reliability

---

## 46. Distance Vector Routing

Each router maintains distance estimates to destinations.

Basic idea:

### Key Insight

Router knows the distance through neighbors.

A classic recurrence is based on:

$$D_x(y) = \min_v \{ c(x,v) + D_v(y) \}$$

## Characteristics

neighbor-based information

iterative updates

simpler

slower convergence in some situations

Example protocol:

### Key Insight

RIP

## Problem

Count-to-infinity.

---

# 47. Link State Routing

Every router builds a map of the network.

Steps:

```
Discover neighbors
↓
Measure link costs
↓
Create link-state information
↓
Flood information
↓
Build topology database
↓
Run shortest-path algorithm
```

Common algorithm:

### Key Insight

Dijkstra

Example protocol:

### Key Insight

OSPF

## Memory

### Key Insight

Link State = Know the map.

---



## 48. Path Vector Routing

Used especially for routing between autonomous systems.

Instead of simply advertising a distance, routers advertise path information.

Example:

```
AS1 → AS3 → AS7
```

A router can use policy and path information to select routes.

Main protocol:

**Key Insight**

**BGP**

### Memory

```
Distance Vector → RIP
Link State      → OSPF
Path Vector     → BGP
```

---

## 49. Congestion Control

Congestion occurs when offered traffic exceeds network capacity.

```
Traffic in
↓
Router Queue
↓
[ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ] [ ]
↓
Overflow
↓
Packet loss
```

Effects:

- delay
- packet loss
- retransmissions
- reduced throughput

### Congestion vs Flow Control

#### Flow control

Protects the receiver.

#### Congestion control

Protects the network.

---

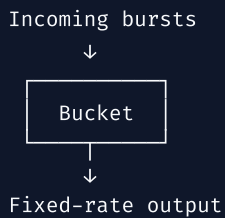
## Congestion-control approaches

---

traffic shaping  
admission control  
queue management  
congestion avoidance  
rate control

### Leaky Bucket

Controls output at a relatively fixed rate.



### Token Bucket

Tokens accumulate at a controlled rate.

Packets require tokens to transmit.

Allows controlled bursts.

---

## 50. Traffic Management

---

Goal:

### Key Insight

Use network resources efficiently while maintaining acceptable service quality.

Includes:

QoS  
queue management  
scheduling  
traffic shaping  
admission control  
congestion avoidance

### QoS dimensions

bandwidth  
delay  
jitter  
packet loss

## Memory

### Key Insight

$\text{QoS} = \text{Bandwidth} + \text{Delay} + \text{Jitter} + \text{Loss}$

## 51. SMTP

### Simple Mail Transfer Protocol

Used primarily for sending/relaying email.

Typical ports:

```
25 → SMTP relay
587 → message submission
```

Basic flow:

```
Sender
↓
Mail Server
↓
Internet
↓
Recipient Mail Server
```

SMTP is primarily a **sending/transfer** protocol.

## 52. DNS

### Domain Name System

Maps domain names to network information, especially IP addresses.

```
www.example.com
↓
DNS
↓
IP address
```

### Hierarchy

```
Root
↓
TLD
↓
Authoritative domain
↓
Host
```

## Important records

| Record | Purpose        |
|--------|----------------|
| A      | IPv4 address   |
| AAAA   | IPv6 address   |
| MX     | Mail server    |
| CNAME  | Canonical name |
| NS     | Name server    |
| TXT    | Text/metadata  |

Port:

53

DNS commonly uses UDP for ordinary queries, with TCP also used in situations such as zone transfers and responses requiring it.

---

## 53. HTTP

### HyperText Transfer Protocol

Used for web communication.

Basic model:

```
Client — HTTP Request → Server
Client ← HTTP Response — Server
```

### Common methods

```
GET
POST
PUT
DELETE
```

### Common status codes

```
2xx → Success
3xx → Redirection
4xx → Client error
5xx → Server error
```

Examples:

```
200 → OK
301/302 → Redirect
404 → Not Found
500 → Server Error
```

Ports:

HTTP → 80  
HTTPS → 443

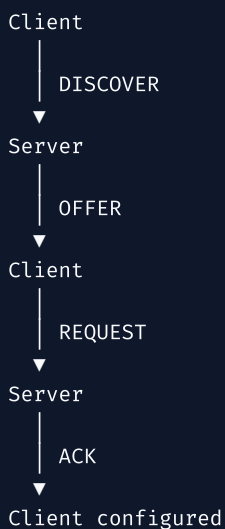
## 54. DHCP

### Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol

Automatically provides configuration such as:

IP address  
subnet mask  
gateway  
DNS server

### DORA



### Memory

#### Key Insight

DORA = Discover → Offer → Request → Acknowledge

Ports:

Server → UDP 67  
Client → UDP 68



## THE MOST IMPORTANT INTEGRATED CONCEPT

### What happens when you type a URL?

Suppose:

```
https://example.com
```

### Step 1 — Device needs network configuration

DHCP can provide:

```
IP
Subnet Mask
Gateway
DNS server
```

### Step 2 — DNS resolution

```
example.com
↓
DNS
↓
Server IP
```

### Step 3 — Transport connection

For HTTPS over TCP:

```
TCP 3-way handshake
```

```
SYN
SYN + ACK
ACK
```

### Step 4 — HTTP/HTTPS request

```
GET / ...
```

### Step 5 — IP routing

Packet travels:

```
Host
↓
Default Gateway
↓
Routers
↓
Server
```

### Step 6 — Link-layer transmission

Locally:

```
Ethernet / Wi-Fi
```

## Step 7 — Server response

```
HTTP response
↓
TCP
↓
IP
↓
Ethernet/Wi-Fi
↓
Browser
```

## Step 8 — Browser renders webpage

```
HTML
CSS
JavaScript
Images
etc.
```

This single scenario connects **M1 + M4 + M5**.

The uploaded question bank specifically asks for this complete URL → webpage journey.

---

## ACTUAL UPLOADED PYQ PATTERNS

These are not invented; they come from the DCCN papers available in your uploaded files.

### 2025 AI323 Mid

Port vs logical vs physical address

TCP/IP architecture

Eb/No

Half vs full duplex

LAN vs WAN

Communication vs transmission

Transmission impairments

Shannon capacity

Satellite microwave

NRZ-L / NRZ-I / AMI / Manchester / Differential Manchester

### 2025 AI323 End

IPv4 header

TCP/IP architecture

PCM

Satellite microwave

Sliding window

Stop-and-Wait ARQ vs Go-Back-N

CRC numerical

Multiplexing/access methods

LLC  
Internetworking  
Circuit vs packet switching

## 2025 IT365 Mid

Transmission modes  
Data communication components  
Data Link Layer  
OSI vs TCP/IP  
SNR  
Transmission impairments  
Guided vs unguided media  
Delta Modulation vs PCM  
Parity  
CRC

## 2025 IT365 End

OSI vs TCP/IP  
Noise  
NRZI  
Differential Manchester  
PCM  
Unguided media  
CRC numerical  
TDM  
Synchronous vs statistical TDM  
Datagram vs virtual circuit  
Dijkstra  
ATM  
---

## ULTRA-HIGH-YIELD 20

---

Your uploaded study guide itself identifies these as the **20 highest-priority questions/topics**.



OSI Model  
TCP/IP Architecture  
OSI vs TCP/IP  
Guided Transmission Media  
Analog vs Digital Signal  
Manchester Encoding  
ASK/FSK/PSK/QAM  
CRC  
Hamming Code



Stop-and-Wait vs Sliding Window

HDLC Frame

FDM vs TDM

Circuit vs Packet Switching

Cellular Networks / 1G-5G

Network Topologies

VLAN

IPv4 vs IPv6

TCP vs UDP

Routing — RIP/OSPF/BGP

DNS/HTTP/SMTP/DHCP

---

## FORMULA SHEET

---

### Transmission

---

$$\text{Bandwidth} = f_H - f_L$$

$$\text{Transmission Delay} = \text{Packet Size} / \text{Data Rate}$$

$$\text{Propagation Delay} = \text{Distance} / \text{Propagation Speed}$$

---

### Nyquist

---

$$C = 2B \log_2 L$$

---

### Shannon

---

$$C = B \log_2(1 + S/N)$$

---

### SNR conversion

---

$$\text{SNR(dB)} = 10 \log_{10}(S/N)$$

---

### Subnetting

---

$$\text{Number of subnets} = 2^{\text{borrowed bits}}$$

```
Addresses/subnet = 2^host bits
```

## Hamming

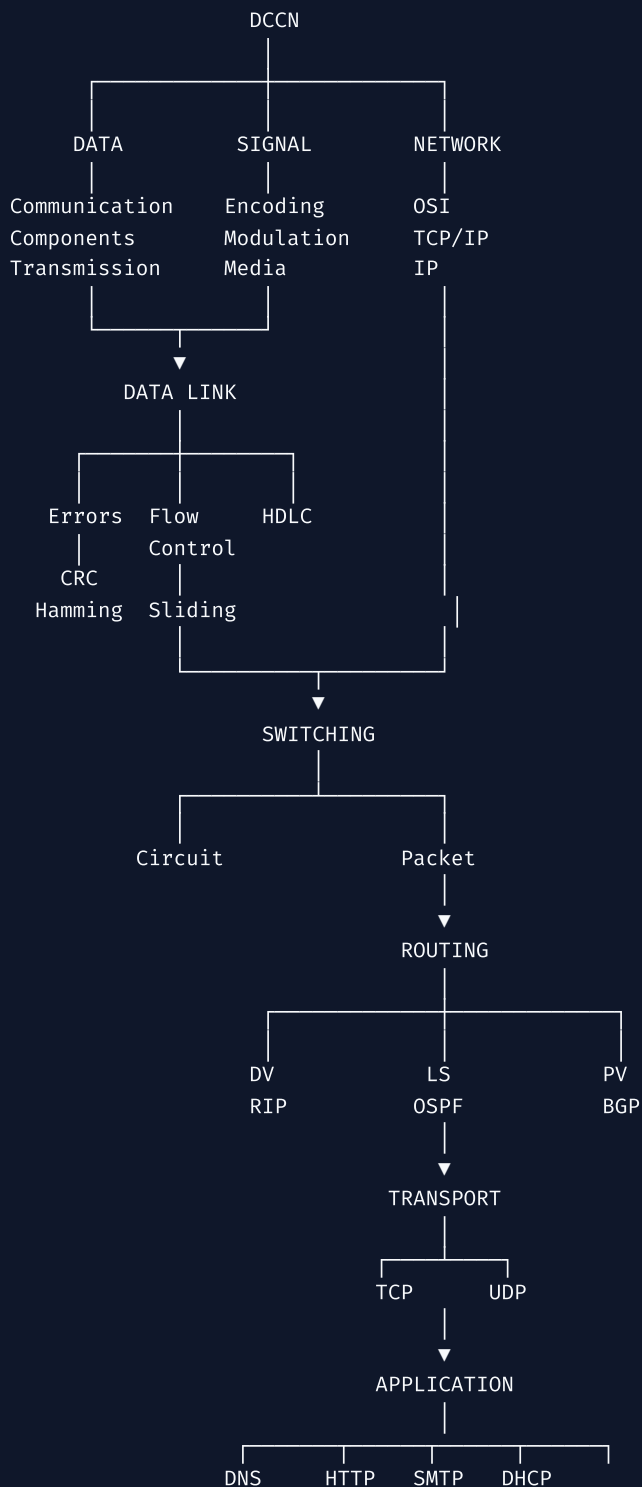
```
2^r ≥ m + r + 1
```

## CRC

```
Append r zeros  
→ modulo-2 divide  
→ remainder = CRC  
→ append CRC
```

## MASTER MEMORY MAP

You should be able to reconstruct the whole course from this:



## NEUROSCIENCE-BASED STUDY SYSTEM FOR DCCN

Don't read this entire thing repeatedly.

Use:

### 1. Retrieval before rereading

Close the notes and answer:

### Key Insight

"What are the 7 OSI layers?"

Then check.

---

## 2. Generation

Before seeing a solution, try:

```
Data = 1010011110
Generator = 1011
```

and perform CRC yourself.

---

## 3. Dual coding

For every major concept, **draw it**.

Especially:

OSI

TCP/IP

communication model

satellite

Manchester

CRC division

Hamming positions

HDLC

FDM/TDM

switching

cellular cells

topologies

VLAN

Ethernet

TCP handshake

routing

---

## 4. Interleaving

Don't study:

```
CRC → CRC → CRC → CRC
```

Instead:

CRC  
OSI  
Hamming  
TCP  
Manchester  
CRC  
Routing

This improves discrimination between similar concepts.

## 5. Spaced repetition

Day 0 → Learn  
Day 1 → Recall  
Day 3 → Recall  
Day 7 → Recall  
Day 14 → Recall  
Day 30 → Recall

# DCCN EXAM ANSWER FORMULA

For a **5/10-mark theory question**, use:

Definition  
↓  
Diagram  
↓  
Working  
↓  
Components / Steps  
↓  
Advantages  
↓  
Disadvantages  
↓  
Application  
↓  
Comparison / conclusion

For a **numerical**:

Given  
↓  
Formula / rule  
↓  
Substitution  
↓  
Step-by-step calculation  
↓  
Final answer boxed

For a **comparison**:

Definition

↓

Table

↓

Example

↓

When to use which

---

## TOP NUMERICALS YOU MUST MASTER

---

If your goal is high marks, don't treat DCCN as only theory.

Practice these **from scratch**:

★★★★★ CRC

★★★★★ Hamming Code

★★★★★ Nyquist

★★★★★ Shannon

★★★★★ Subnetting

★★★★★ Transmission delay

★★★★★ Propagation delay

★★★★★ Line-code waveform generation

★★★ Dijkstra

★★★ Sliding-window calculations

---

## COMPLETE 52-TOPIC TRACKER

---

### M1 — 13/13

☐ Communication Model

☐ Data Communications

☐ Networks

☐ Internet

☐ OSI Model

☐ TCP/IP Architecture

☐ Standards & Protocol Layers

☐ Internet Applications

☐ Data Transmission Concepts

☐ Analog Data Transmission

☐ Digital Data Transmission

☐ Transmission Impairments

☐ Channel Capacity

### M2 — 6/6

☐ Guided Transmission Media

☐ Wireless Transmission & Propagation

- ☐ Digital Signaling
- ☐ Analog Signaling
- ☐ Encoding Techniques
- ☐ Modulation Techniques

### **M3 — 8/8**

- ☐ Types of Errors
- ☐ Error Detection
- ☐ Error Correction
- ☐ Flow Control
- ☐ Error Control
- ☐ HDLC
- ☐ FDM
- ☐ TDM

### **M4 — 9/9**

- ☐ Switching Network
- ☐ Circuit-Switching Networks
- ☐ Circuit-Switching Concepts
- ☐ Packet-Switching Principles
- ☐ Cellular Network Principles
- ☐ Cellular Generations
- ☐ Network Topologies
- ☐ LAN Protocol Architecture
- ☐ VLAN

### **M5 — 16/16**

- ☐ Traditional Ethernet
- ☐ High-Speed Ethernet
- ☐ IEEE 802.11
- ☐ IP
- ☐ IP Addressing
- ☐ Transport Protocols
- ☐ Routing
- ☐ Distance Vector
- ☐ Link State
- ☐ Path Vector
- ☐ Congestion Control
- ☐ Traffic Management
- ☐ SMTP
- ☐ DNS
- ☐ HTTP
- ☐ DHCP

**Total: 52/52 topics.**

## The most important thing

For **DCCN**, your learning should be much more **problem-oriented** than CD:

### Key Insight

**Understand → draw → derive → calculate → recall → solve PYQ.**

And the highest-value sequence is:

**M1:** OSI/TCP-IP + transmission + Nyquist/Shannon

→ **M2:** waveforms + media + modulation

→ **M3:** CRC + Hamming + ARQ + HDLC + TDM

→ **M4:** switching + cellular + topology + VLAN

→ **M5:** IP + subnetting + TCP/UDP + routing + application protocols.

Your uploaded material independently highlights essentially the same high-priority cluster, particularly **OSI/TCP-IP, CRC, Hamming, flow control, HDLC, FDM/TDM, switching, cellular networking, IP/TCP/UDP, routing and DNS/HTTP/SMTP/DHCP.**